



Figure 3: Chat window

click on **Contacts**→**Add Contact** and to start a chat: **Actions**→**Start a chat**.

You can also add a number of plugins by clicking on **Plugins**→**Available plugins**. Here, I've installed a simple plugin, **MotD**, which displays a message whenever a user logs in. After installing it, you need to configure it. So go to **Users/Groups**→**MotD Properties**. Here, type your message and enable **MotD**. Now, whenever users log in, this message will be displayed to them. There are plugins for Asterisk integration, clustering and monitoring, which are quite useful and you can integrate them to your server as per your requirements.

Figure 4: *MotD* message

This was a quick exploration of a chat server that is easy-to-configure, manage and use. Since Openfire is cross-platform, you can install it on your favourite platform—whether it is Windows, Linux or Mac—and start exploring it. Just go for it, and you will enjoy how easy it is to configure and use Openfire. **END** 

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